

Regions Bank v. Benedortse

The complaint places mobile-app transactional security at issue: identification of hardware components, registration and user-agreement identifiers, software-app download, and a verification entity's authorization decision. Expert questions are likely to concern mobile-app and backend architecture, device identifiers, token and credential paths, and allocation of actions between app, user device, and bank systems.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-25	U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Alabama	2:26-cv-01504	Patent Declaratory Judgment

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION

Regions Bank v. Benedortse LLC

FORUM / DOCKET

U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Alabama / 2:26-cv-01504

FILED / TYPE

2026-08-25 / patent declaratory judgment

PUBLIC DOCKET[Open docket](#)**VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD**

The public complaint identifies Regions Bank v. Benedortse LLC, Civil Action No. 2:26-cv-01504, in the Northern District of Alabama, filed August 25, 2026. Regions seeks declaratory relief concerning U.S. Patent Nos. 8,260,723, 8,463,713, and 9,400,979, titled 'Transactional Security Over a Network.' The pleading says Benedortse accused the Regions Mobile App and provided a claim chart. These are allegations and positions in a pleading, not findings.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Robert H. Fowlkes - Counsel for Regions Bank, Maynard Nexsen PC. Verified complaint fact and analytical inference: the signature block identifies Fowlkes as counsel for Regions and prints his exact professional email. That makes him a plausible initial recipient for preliminary expert-search research; it does not establish purchasing authority.

bfowlkes@maynardnexsen.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

The complaint places mobile-app transactional security at issue: identification of hardware components, registration and user-agreement identifiers, software-app download, and a verification entity's authorization decision. Expert questions are likely to concern mobile-app and backend architecture, device identifiers, token and credential paths, and allocation of actions between app, user device, and bank systems.

Secondary-source limitation: The complaint and patents are preliminary public sources only. Claim construction, prosecution history, the cited claim chart, mobile-app versions, backend source code, telemetry, configuration, and discovery must control any final opinion. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. Patent No. 8,260,723](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 8,463,713](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 9,400,979](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Device and hardware-component identification

What device and hardware identifiers are collected by the Regions Mobile App, what component creates them, and do they perform the function required by the asserted claims?

Potential evidence: Mobile-app source and binaries, device logs, SDK documentation, backend schemas, API traces, and controlled testing.

02 Registration and user-agreement identifiers

Which actor creates, stores, transmits, and verifies any customer, device, agreement, or account identifier, and how do those data paths compare with the asserted claim language?

Potential evidence: Identity-service design documents, source code, database schemas, API specifications, audit logs, and test accounts.

03 Verification-entity architecture

Is there a verification entity separate from the mobile app and bank backend, and what information does it receive and return for an authorization decision?

Potential evidence: Architecture diagrams, service ownership records, network traces, source code, security controls, and vendor agreements.

04 Authorization-decision sequence

What event sequence leads to approval, denial, challenge, or step-up authentication in the app, and is an asserted verification response technically material to the final transaction decision?

Potential evidence: Workflow specifications, policy engines, API logs, transaction traces, code, test plans, and incident records.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Credential and cryptographic handling

How are credentials, device binding data, tokens, keys, and signed assertions generated, protected, transmitted, and evaluated?

Potential evidence: Key-management configuration, token formats, SDKs, cryptographic design records, protocol captures, and source code.

06 Client, backend, and third-party attribution

Which functions are performed by a user, handset, mobile OS, bank app, bank service, identity provider, fraud service, or network operator?

Potential evidence: Source repositories, architecture and vendor documentation, contracts, configuration, API traces, and technical testimony.

07 Historical versions and POSITA baseline

Which app, SDK, backend, and security-service versions operated during the relevant period, and what did a skilled artisan understand about mobile transactional security at the patents' priority dates?

Potential evidence: Release archives, source-control history, contemporaneous standards, patents, papers, platform documentation, and a supported POSITA definition.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 David Wagner, PhD

Professor of Computer Science, University of California, Berkeley

TECHNICAL FIT

Computer security and program analysis fit mobile-app code, device signals, and authorization paths.

RELEVANT WORK

Berkeley profile identifies computer-security and program-analysis research, including smartphone security.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Profile does not establish experience with the particular products or claims.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | daw@cs.berkeley.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Dan Boneh, PhD

Professor of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering, Stanford University

TECHNICAL FIT

Applied cryptography, authentication, and key handling fit token and verification questions.

RELEVANT WORK

Stanford profile identifies applied-cryptography and computer-security research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Narrower fit for protocols than full bank-app implementation.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | dabo@cs.stanford.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Hovav Shacham, PhD

Professor of Computer Science, University of Texas at Austin

TECHNICAL FIT

Systems security and cryptography fit device identity and software-security evidence.

RELEVANT WORK

UT profile identifies systems-security and cryptography research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

May require a separate financial-services implementation specialist.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | hovav@cs.utexas.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Patrick Traynor, PhD

Professor of Computer and Information Science and Engineering, University of Florida

TECHNICAL FIT

Mobile systems and security fit app-to-service communication and handset evidence.

RELEVANT WORK

UF profile describes security and privacy research with a mobile-systems focus.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Profile alone does not establish banking-product experience.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | traynor@ufl.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Kevin R. B. Butler, PhD

Professor, University of Florida

TECHNICAL FIT

Trusted computing and systems security fit device trust and attestation questions.

RELEVANT WORK

UF profile identifies systems security and trusted computing.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Needs diligence on financial-service and testimony background.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | butler@ufl.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Gang Tan, PhD

Professor, Penn State

TECHNICAL FIT

Software security, verification, and Android research fit app and policy architecture.

RELEVANT WORK

Penn State directory identifies software-security and Android-related research interests.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

May be stronger on software properties than commercial banking workflows.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | gxt29@psu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Zhiqiang Lin, PhD

Professor of Computer Science and Engineering, Ohio State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Binary and software-security analysis fit mobile-app implementation review.

RELEVANT WORK

Ohio State profile describes binary and software-security research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Does not by itself show expertise in transactional policy services.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | lin.3021@osu.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Wenke Lee, PhD

Professor, Georgia Institute of Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Mobile and systems security fit malware-resistance, device signals, and runtime behavior.

RELEVANT WORK

Georgia Tech profile identifies security research including malware and mobile-security topics.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Profile does not establish bank-app or identity-service specialization.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | wenke.lee@cc.gatech.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Suman Jana, PhD

Associate Professor of Computer Science, Columbia University

TECHNICAL FIT

Program analysis and vulnerability discovery fit app implementation and security-control review.

RELEVANT WORK

Columbia profile identifies systems and software-security research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Could be an issue-specific software-analysis candidate.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | suman@cs.columbia.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Simson Garfinkel, PhD

Professor of Practice, George Washington University

TECHNICAL FIT

Digital forensics, privacy engineering, and information-security practice fit logs, system evidence, and security architecture.

RELEVANT WORK

GW profile identifies information security, privacy, and digital-forensics work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in cited public profile.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Role may be better for evidence and systems practice than core claim construction.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | simson@acm.org | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74695585/regions-bank-v-benedortse-llc/>

Public professional email source: <https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.alnd.201540/gov.uscourts.alnd.201540.1.0.pdf>

Public technical context source: <https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.alnd.201540/gov.uscourts.alnd.201540.1.0.pdf>

LIMITATIONS

The complaint and patents are preliminary public sources only. Claim construction, prosecution history, the cited claim chart, mobile-app versions, backend source code, telemetry, configuration, and discovery must control any final opinion.

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